



▲ **In an effort** to keep the railway traffic moving along the main arteries of the country, the Dufferin Bridge (later renamed Malviya Bridge) over the River Ganges in Varanasi was regirded for double-line traffic and opened by the end of 1947.

Independence and self-reliance

For decades, rolling stock had mostly been imported. With Independence came a renewed effort to develop an indigenous industry. Matthai reiterated its importance as, out of the available 8,400 broad- and metre-gauge locomotives, 2,900 had completed their period of service. Gradually, the availability and import of spare parts increased and was reflected in a more upbeat Budget speech the following year in 1948. This was also because Indian manufacturers were scheduled to deliver 4,050 general service wagons and expected to deliver 146 new locomotives during 1948.

The efforts slowly increased workshop outputs, efficient transportation of imported food grains, and improved the capacity of marshalling yards. Equally prominent on the Indian Government's list of priorities was to increase line capacity. Bridges were regirded for